KPS PUBLIC SCHOOLS • STUDENT TECH BENCH PROGRAM

Evaluator Key — managers only

# Tier 1 — Basic Repair

T1

Safe hands, the right tools, and the repairs every Tech Bench student does first.

## In this guide


1 Answer key

2 Scoring the knowledge check

3 Running the practical exam

4 Awarding the certification


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**Keep this away from candidates.** This key is for lead techs and managers. Don't leave it on the bench or share the file.

# 1 Answer key

| # | Answer | Why |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **C** — The battery | Battery first, battery last. Nothing inside should have power while you work. |
| 2 | **A** — Check the keyboard layout (S4) | Swapped symbols are a layout setting almost every time. |
| 3 | **D** — Plastic pick | Plastic only near electronics and plastic shells. |
| 4 | **B** — Stop, don't touch it, get an adult | A swollen battery is a fire risk. Stop and get an adult. |
| 5 | **B** — Flip the latch up first, then slide it out | A ZIF needs zero force once the latch is open. Pulling a locked ribbon tears it. |
| 6 | **D** — Plug in the charger and wait | A battery that has been unplugged often needs the charger to wake up. |
| 7 | **A** — Only in the long-screw holes | A long screw in a short hole can punch through a board. |
| 8 | **C** — Trackpad | Tier 1: keyboard, trackpad, bezel, battery, charger, case. |
| 9 | **D** — Charger 30 min, try both ports, hard reset | Cheapest, least invasive fix first. |
| 10 | **B** — With the cover still off, before the last screws | Finding a loose cable now saves taking it apart again. |
| 11 | **C** — Static damage to boards | Static can kill a board without a visible spark. |
| 12 | **A** — Find where it goes before closing the ticket | A leftover screw means something isn't fastened, or it's loose inside the device. |
| 13 | **A** — Files saved on the device (like Downloads) | Cloud files are safe; local files are erased. Warn the student first. |
| 14 | **C** — Pass it to a Tier 3 tech or lead tech | The guide level says how hard the job is on that model. Level 3 jobs need a lead tech. |
| 15 | **D** — What you found, what you tried, the part used | Good notes let anyone pick the ticket up and let the bench spot repeat failures. |

# 2 Scoring the knowledge check

- One point per question. Score 80% or better (12 of 15) on the written check.
- Go over every missed question with the candidate, using the "Why" column, before they leave.
- A candidate who misses the pass mark can retake a different-order version after a week. Shuffle the answer letters when you reprint.

# 3 Running the practical exam

- Allow about 45 minutes. Set up the devices and any planted faults before the candidate arrives.
- Watch, don't coach. Step in only for safety.
- Mark each task Pass or Fail against the "To pass" column. All tasks must pass.
- Any automatic-fail item ends the exam immediately.

| Task | Set up beforehand | Watch for |
|---|---|---|
| **Bench setup and safety** | Set up the bench and power down a test device correctly. | Strap on, mat clear, screw tray, photos taken, device off and unplugged. |
| **Open and battery** | Remove the bottom cover (or deck) and unplug the battery. | Plastic tools only, screws laid out in pattern, battery unplugged first, by the plug body. |
| **Connector drill** | Unlock, remove, inspect and reseat two different ribbon cables. | Latch opened before pulling, ribbon in straight and fully, latch closed. |
| **Tier 1 repair** | Do one Tier 1 repair chosen by the evaluator (battery, keyboard, trackpad or bezel). | Follows the device guide, tests before closing, verify checks pass. |
| **Software fix** | Diagnose a planted software fault (wrong layout or a device that needs a hard reset). | Finds and fixes it without opening the device. |
| **Close-out** | Reassemble, account for every screw, and write the ticket notes. | No leftover screws, clear notes, part logged. |

**Automatic fail items.** Prying with a metal tool against the battery or a board; Working inside with the battery connected; Pulling a locked ribbon cable; Ignoring a swollen battery; Leaving screws unaccounted for.

# 4 Awarding the certification

- Check every requirement on the sign-off page is signed, including the prerequisite.
- Sign and date the candidate's sign-off page.
- In the portal, open Certifications, find the candidate, and click the box for this certification. It's recorded with your name and the date, and logged.
- If a certified student has a safety violation or repeated comebacks, remove the certification in the portal (click the check again) and note why in the audit log reason or the student's file.